

Professional Judgment Appeal Form Instructions

When you fill out the [FAFSA](#) (Free Application for Federal Student Aid), it uses tax information from two years ago. For many families, that information may no longer reflect what is happening now.

If your family's financial situation has changed significantly, our office may be able to review your situation through a [Professional Judgment Appeal](#).

A Professional Judgment Appeal allows our financial aid team to look at your current financial circumstances and, with proper documentation, make adjustments to certain FAFSA information. If approved, this review may change your [Student Aid Index \(SAI\)](#), which could affect your financial aid eligibility. We encourage you to email or call our office to discuss your appeal. Prior to submitting an appeal, please read the following information.

- If you have been selected for [Verification](#), that process must be completed prior to filing an appeal.
- During the appeal review, if any of the provided documentation conflicts with any information previously reported on the FAFSA, then our office is required to resolve the conflicting information regardless of if the appeal is approved or denied. This requirement could cause an increase or a decrease to your existing financial aid award.
- We may have to request additional information after reviewing the required items listed on this form.
- Please allow a minimum of three (3) weeks for processing.
- Please ensure that you provide all required documentation upon submission. Fill in every blank. Sign where required.
- **Approval of an appeal does not guarantee additional aid.**
- **Appeals cannot be used simply to request more financial aid.**

GRADUATE STUDENTS: This type of appeal is not beneficial to you as your financial aid options through our office are limited to student loans. Please contact our office to discuss other options.

Reasons for Appeal:

Examples include, but are not limited to the following:

- Unemployment of more than four (4) weeks following job loss
- Death of a student's parent (or spouse if student is independent)
- The family has incurred and paid extraordinary medical/dental expenses.
- The student or the student's parents have separated or divorced.
- The student or parent(s) no longer receives recurring income such as child support or other sources of income.
- A one-time, nonrecurring payment that is not indicative of annual income and is intended for a specific, designated purpose.

Please review the attached Professional Judgment Appeal Form which lists the documentation needed for each type of appeal. If you choose to pursue the appeal, please submit all required documents upon initial submission.

To submit your appeal, select the Professional Judgment Appeal Form in our secure [document uploader](#). Do not send your appeal via email. Virginia Tech does not open email attachments. Do not upload this instruction page.

2026-2027

Professional Judgment Appeal Form

Student ID #: 906873191 Email: ethanvt08@vt.edu

Student's Name: Arreguin, Ethan
Last First

Deadline information: Although there is no specific deadline for submitting a Professional Judgment Appeal, it must be fully processed while the student is actively enrolled. Since the appeal involves multiple steps, submitting it later in the semester may risk incomplete processing. If any step is not finished before the student's enrollment ends, the appeal cannot be completed.

Required for submission:

- Professional Judgment Appeal Form, completed and signed by both student and parent (if student is dependent).
- Written statement by student or parent describing the appeal circumstances. Use the box provided on this form or attach a separate signed document.
- Additional documentation listed below.

REASON FOR APPEAL	REQUIRED DOCUMENTATION
☐ Significant reduction in student or parent(s) income: Please note that the earliest we will consider an appeal due to unemployment will be four (4) weeks from the date of separation. Important Income-Based Appeal Information: If prior-year tax information does not accurately reflect your current financial situation and an income projection for the current tax year is required, University Scholarships and Financial Aid requires a minimum of five to six months of actual income documentation before a projection can be completed. This ensures that the projected income is as accurate and reasonable as possible. For example, if employment ends in January, documentation of actual income received from January through at least May must be submitted before we can project income for the remainder of the year. Name of the person unemployed: _____ Date of unemployment: _____	• Copy of separation notice, showing last day worked • Documentation of unemployment benefits dated within 90 days of submitting this appeal. If you chose not to apply for unemployment, let us know in your written statement • Final pay stub and documentation of severance pay (if applicable). • Copy of signed 2025 federal tax return and all 2025 W-2s. • Copies of most recent pay stubs for all 2026 employment • Documentation of Worker's Compensation • Documentation of employer disability payments • Document all other's sources of income (taxed & untaxed)

Student ID Number: 906873191

Last Name: Arreguin

☒ The parent's/student's separation or divorce from their spouse Select one: ☒ Dependent students: Parents separated ☐ Independent Students: Student and spouse separated Submit documentation that corresponds to the student type selected above. Dependent students must provide required documentation for each parent. Independent students must provide required documentation for themselves and their spouse.	• Copy of all 2024 W-2's • Asset Worksheet • Mortgage/lease for both parties showing separate residences • Utility bill for both parties for the residence on the mortgage/lease • Signed statement explaining who provides the most support to the student - o Dependent students must identify which parent provides the majority of financial support in their statement. If the parent providing the majority of support is not the parent with the higher income, the statement must clearly explain this circumstance.
☐ Death of student's parent or spouse (if independent) since completion of the FAFSA.	• Copy of the parent's or spouse's death certificate. • Copy of all 2024 W-2's
☐ Received a one-time, nonrecurring payment that is not indicative of annual income and is intended for a specific, designated purpose. Please note: Non-recurring income must have been specifically committed or earmarked for non-educational expenses to be considered unavailable for educational costs.	• Documentation of amount and the source of the funding (examples may include 401(k) or IRA early withdrawal, settlement payout, etc.) • Documentation of how funds were spent or obligated. • Copy of all 2024 W-2s.
☐ Extraordinary family medical/dental expenses not covered or reimbursed by insurance. Paid expenses can be appealed for one calendar year, either 2024 or 2025. Select the calendar year in which the paid expenses occurred (choose one): ☐ 2024 ☐ 2025	• Submit proof of medical expenses paid in the calendar year indicated on this form • Please note: your expenses must exceed a specific amount determined by your income to qualify as extraordinary medical expenses.
☐ Reduction or loss of recurring income such as child support, taxable Social Security, or other sources of income for the student or parent(s).	• Termination of recurring income: documentation of the monthly benefit amount received and date of benefit termination. • Reduction of recurring income: documentation of both original benefit amount, date of reduction, and reduced benefit amount.
☐ Other Explain your circumstances on the following page of the appeal form.	• Explain your situation • Please note: Submission of this statement initiates your appeal. After reviewing your explanation, our office will request the required supporting documentation.

Please provide a detailed explanation of your circumstances. Your statement should include:

- What happened and when it began.
- Whether the situation is ongoing or temporary.
- How it affects your household's current finances compared to what was reported on the FAFSA.
- Who is affected (parent, student, spouse).
- Any steps taken to address the situation (e.g., job search, assistance).
- Information that supports or clarifies the documentation you are submitting.

Statement describing the reason for your appeal

I am requesting a review of my financial aid eligibility due to a change in my family's circumstances that is not accurately reflected on my FAFSA.

My parents separated and signed a formal separation agreement on September 18, 2025. At the time I completed my FAFSA, I was unaware that my parents had officially separated because they had not yet informed me of the situation. As a result, I completed the FAFSA as though my parents were still together.

This situation is ongoing and continues to affect my family's financial circumstances. Since the separation, my father has had to secure a separate residence, and both of my parents are now responsible for maintaining separate households and living expenses. This has created additional financial obligations that were not reflected in the financial information reported on my FAFSA.

The separation has affected every member of my immediate family, including myself, my father, my mother, and my sister. The financial resources that were previously supporting one household must now support two separate households.

To help address these financial challenges, I have been saving the income I earn from my engineering internship during the summer to contribute toward my college expenses. My family is also providing the requested documentation so that Virginia Tech can accurately evaluate our current financial situation.

Although the FAFSA was submitted after the September 18, 2025 separation agreement was signed, the information reported on the FAFSA reflected my understanding at the time, as I did not yet know that my parents had officially separated. Because I currently reside primarily with my father and receive the majority of my financial support from him, I am requesting that my financial aid eligibility be evaluated based on his financial circumstances.

To support this request, I am submitting the separation agreement, 2024 and 2025 tax documentation, a signed statement identifying which parent provides the majority of my support, mortgage or lease documentation, utility bills demonstrating separate residences, and any additional documentation requested by the university.

Thank you for your time and consideration of my circumstances.

Important Notes

- Allow at least three weeks after submitting all requested documents for your appeal result.
- Any additional aid received from this one-time appeal is only for this year. It will not be a recurring award.

If I purposely give false or misleading information, I may receive a fine, a prison sentence, or both. By signing this form, I certify that all information is complete and correct.

Student's Signature: _____ **Date:** _____
Electronic Signatures are not allowed

Parent's Signature: _____ **Date:** _____
Required for dependent students only